



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the reality of free will.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

A compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist believer in free will rejects premise (2).

This is the consequence argument.

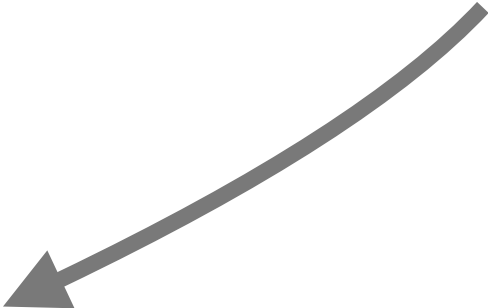
Now that we have a grip on determinism and on one view of free will which would arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the central argument against the view that free will is compatible with determinism.

No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
distant past.

No one has any choice
about what the laws of
nature are.

No one has any choice about the combination of the state of the world in the distant past + the laws of nature.





If determinism is true,
then the state of the
world in the distant past
+ the laws of nature
necessitate every future
action.

Now remember that, if determinism is true, the state of the world 10 million years ago is consistent with only one possible future.

A different way to put this point is that,
if determinism is true, the laws of nature
+ the state of the universe in the distant
past **necessitate** everything about the
future.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



then DECISION happens. (3)

1. No one has any choice about events which

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

varlatatie + the last of the

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

2. None has any choice about DIDS ATJR.

theorie about the fact that if DNR

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

future is not distant with the state of the

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

happened in the distant past.



of interest.

3. If determined, the only one

then DECISION. (4,5)

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

if P , then Q , then one has any choice



and none has any choice about whether,

about whether @.

combination of four - that No

choice principle, and determinism

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice about the laws of nature, then no

rules out free will.

seem quite plausible, the argument

Since the first three of these theses

hence that free will is incompatible with

seems to show that if determinism is

dearminism.

true, there are no free actions — and





The master argument against the reality of free will

believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

which arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the

Now that we have a grip on determinism and on the view of free will

central argument against the view that free will is compatible with





distasteful.

states that the world is the

No one has any choice about the



None has any choice

about what the laws of

in air.



None has any choice about the

world in the distant past + the

contribution to the

laws that are.



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acai in.

needs it at every future

the first state of the

+the laws of nature

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past necessities at everything about the

+ the state of the universe in the distant

future.

A different way to put this point is that,

if determinism is true, the laws of nature

Real/|the master argument:

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

for (2), and one for (3).



No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
distant past.

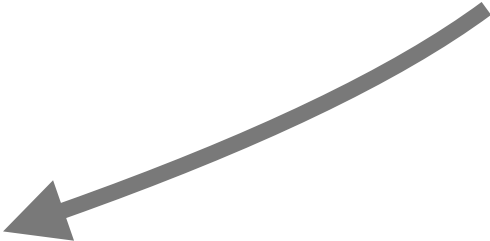


No one has any choice
about what the laws of
nature are.



No one has any choice about the combination of the state of the world in the distant past + the laws of nature.







If determinism is true,
then the state of the
world in the distant past
+ the laws of nature
necessitate every future
action.

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